



Sri Parvathi Jadal Ramalingeshwara Swamy Devasthanam

Cheruvugattu



Sthala Puranam

DHYĀNA ŚLOKA

శ్లో॥ శ్రీమద్భార్గవరామనిర్మితమహాద్వివ్యాలయేనంస్థితం
నీహరాచలకన్యకార్థవపుషంబాలేందురేఖాధరం |
బ్రహ్మేంద్రాచ్యుతసేవ్యపాదజలజంసద్భక్తకల్పధృమం
సేవేసుందరకష్టశైలనిలయం శ్రీరామలింగంభజే ||

TRANSLITERATION

Śrīmad-bhārgavarāma-nirmita-mahā-divyālayē saṁsthitam
Nihārācala-kanyakārdha-vapuṣaṁ bālēndu-rēkhā-dharam |
Brahmēndrācyuta-sēvya-pāda-jalajam sadbhakta-kalpadrumam
Sēvē sundara-ikṣuśaila-nilayaṁ śrī-rāmaṁlingam bhajē ||

"I bow to Lord Sri Ramalingeshwara, enshrined in the magnificent divine temple established by Sri Bhargava Rama (Parashurama). He shares half His divine form with the daughter of the snowy mountain (Goddess Parvathi) and adorns the crescent moon upon His brow. His lotus feet are venerated by Brahma, Indra, and Achyuta (Vishnu), and He stands as the wish-fulfilling tree (Kalpavriksha) to true devotees. I worship Him, the presiding deity residing upon the sacred, enchanting hill of Ikshvadri."

THE SACRED ORIGINS · POORVA VRUTTAM

In the Treta Yuga, there lived an immensely powerful emperor named **Kartavirya Arjuna**. He was extraordinarily strong and possessed a thousand arms. One day, he went hunting in the forest with his entire retinue. Tired from the hunt, the king arrived at the nearby hermitage of the sage-king Jamadagni to rest. Sage Jamadagni, with the help of his divine wish-fulfilling cow **Shabala**, was able to arrange a sumptuous feast with all six flavours for the emperor's entire retinue within a very short time.

Delighted by this, Kartavirya Arjuna asked the sage to give him the wish-fulfilling cow. Jamadagni advised him, saying, "O King! By the power of its penance, this cow stays on its own accord only with sages; it cannot be kept by force by anyone." Ignoring these words, the emperor ordered his soldiers to forcibly bring the cow and its calf to his kingdom. Having no other option, Jamadagni went to the cow and prayed, "O Mother! I am unable to protect you. Protect yourself, and thereby protect me too." Then, from a hair on the cow's body, a warrior fully equipped with weapons emerged and, in an instant, destroyed Kartavirya Arjuna's entire army.

Unable to contain his anger, Kartavirya Arjuna came to wage war against Jamadagni, whereupon the sage's son, **Parashurama**, defeated him. Kartavirya Arjuna, burning with the desire for revenge, waited for a time when Parashurama was away, attacked the hermitage, and beheaded Sage Jamadagni.

When Parashurama returned to the hermitage and learned of this, he flew into a towering rage, attacked Kartavirya Arjuna's kingdom, severed his thousand arms, and slew him. Even then, his anger unabated, Parashurama circled the earth twenty-one times, slaying every Kshatriya he encountered, and donated the entire earth as a gift to the foremost of Brahmins, Kashyapa Prajapati, the mind-born son of Brahma. At the sacred ford of Shamantapanchaka, he offered tarpana (libations) to his father Jamadagni with that Kshatriya blood.

Thereafter, for the welfare of the universe and wishing the world to flourish in peace and happiness, he consecrated **Shiva Lingas at 108 sacred sites**, pouring the power of his penance — accumulated over hundreds of thousands of years — into each Shiva Linga he installed at every site, thereby establishing peace throughout the universe.

THE DIVINE GLORY OF IKSHVADRI · IKSHVADRI MĀHĀTMYAM

The 108th and culminating Shiva Linga consecrated by Parashurama is enshrined at the holy **Cheruvugattu kshetram**, historically known as Ikshvadri.

The Consecration of the Shiva Linga & Divine Penance

In accordance with the sacred truth "Śivāya Viṣṇu-rūpāya Śiva-rūpāya Viṣṇavē" — affirming that Lord Shiva and Lord Vishnu are one and the same — **Sri Bhargava Rama, better known as Parashurama**, is the divine avatar of Lord Vishnu, descended to cleanse the earth of adharma. Thus, it was Lord Vishnu Himself, in the form of Parashurama, who consecrated this sacred, **west-facing Shiva Linga** atop the holy hill and engaged in rigorous austerities across ages, seeking to infuse the Linga with the supreme fruits of his penance for universal harmony.

The Divine Manifestation & The Sacred Markings

Despite performing penance here with steadfast devotion for hundreds of thousands of years, Lord Shiva did not initially appear. In a surge of devotional despair and righteous wrath, Parashurama struck the consecrated Shiva Linga with his sacred battle-axe (*Parashu*). Immediately, Lord Shiva manifested before him in a brilliant, radiant form with His divine matted locks (*Jadalu*) loosened and flowing. Appeased by such unyielding austerity, Lord Shiva declared, "For all these years you have performed penance and pleased me; this kshetram shall shine as one of the most renowned holy places. From here until the end of Kali Yuga, I shall remain and fulfil the long-cherished desires of my devotees," and with this solemn benediction, merged back into the sacred Shiva Linga. Unlike typical Shiva Lingas that possess a smooth, rounded summit, the crown of this divine Linga bears a distinct crescent moon-shaped cleft caused by the strike of Parashurama's axe, while the posterior surface exhibits a unique, uneven texture mirroring the Lord's flowing matted locks — giving the deity the venerated name **Sri Jadala Ramalingeshwara Swamy**.

Parivara Devatas Atop the Hill

Ascending the sacred hill, the path passes the Koneru and Gogarbhamu to **Sri Kalabhairava Swamy** — the vigilant Kshetrapalaka (guardian deity) of the kshetram — before reaching the entrance of the Main Temple Complex, where **Sri Maha Ganapathi** is enshrined. After darshan of the principal deity, the path passes **Sri Anjaneya Swamy** and **Sri Renuka Yellamma Devi** on the way to Moodu Gundlu, the three sacred rock pools crowned by the revered **Sri Urdhva Lingam**; beside its exit path are enshrined **Sri Parashurama Lingam** and, next to it, **Sri Atma Lingam**. Devotees firmly believe these sacred spots fulfil heartfelt wishes and earnest prayers.

Foot of the Hill

The temple of Sri Parvathi Devi is enshrined at the base of the hill, accompanied by Sri Mallikarjuna Swamy, Subrahmanya Swamy, and Sri Bhadrakali Sametha Veerabhadra Swamy as attendant deities.

Arogyapradata · The Divine Physician

Echoing the sacred proclamation of the Sri Rudram — the supreme Vedic hymn which extols Lord Shiva as "*Prathamō Daivyo Bhisak*" (the foremost and primordial divine physician) — **Sri Parvathi Jadala Ramalingeshwara Swamy is worshipped by millions of pilgrims as Arogyapradata** (the bestower of health), dispelling physical ailments, mental distress, and karmic afflictions.



Lord Shiva's Divine Proclamation

This sacred Linga shall be known as Sri Jadala Ramalingeshwara Swamy .	The kshetram shall be a powerful center of spiritual purification.
Devotees worshipping here shall attain peace, prosperity, and Moksha.	Parashurama shall eternally remain associated with this holy place.